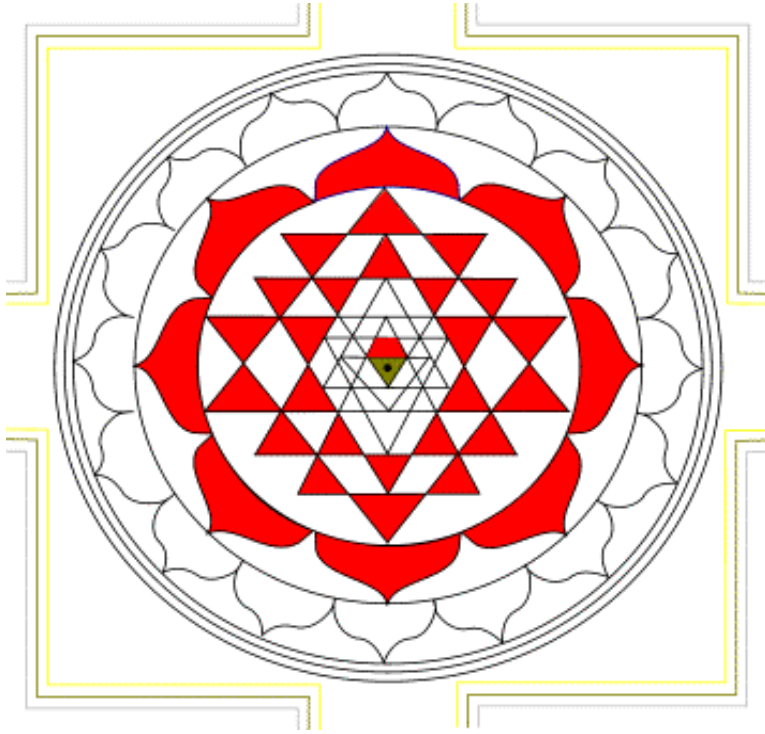




EDITOR IN CHIEF: SWAMI PARANAND TIRTH

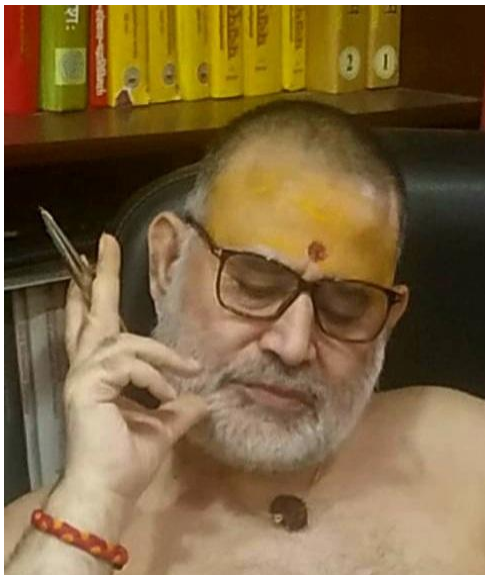
YOGTANTRAGAMA



ISSN NO: 2454-888X

Vol 27 Issue 42

Oct-Dec 2025



From the chief editor's desk 42

Reflections on word transcendence

You talk when you cease to be at peace with your thoughts .

(Khalil Gibran)



The outflow of expressions in the form of a gradual dissociation of word from its meaning has been mulled by various mystics belonging to different world cultures .From ancient Vedic reflections on the four modes of speech or vak up-till the latest advents in linguistics within the intra disciplinary cognitive science and Artificial intelligence we see that the “sure

thing” in the arena of expression is “क्व स्विदस्या परमं जगाम” who can touch the limits of this ever divergent process of reciprocating expression”

One ancient tantrik canon says the self evident gnosis of one’s essential nature is called vimarsha in the vocab of oriental metaphysics . While descending down to grosser realms this vimarsha unites with ignorance and word and meaning and gets condensed in the form Vikalpa or ideation. This phenomena of word meaning separation happens within the transcendental arena ,so the revelation ability or the source of revelations remains unalloyed by the hermeneutic elaborations and other produces of conditioned reasoning . The principle of Pure righteousness or ritam manifests in the form of perfect homogeneity of word and meaning . Only accomplished mystics have an access to this realm .

Further conditioning happens in the arena of individual reason . In this mundane realm of expressions lies the entire gamut of human understanding and its produces. this

तुरीयं वाचं मनुष्याः वदन्ति।
तां विश्वरूपाः पशवो वदन्ति।

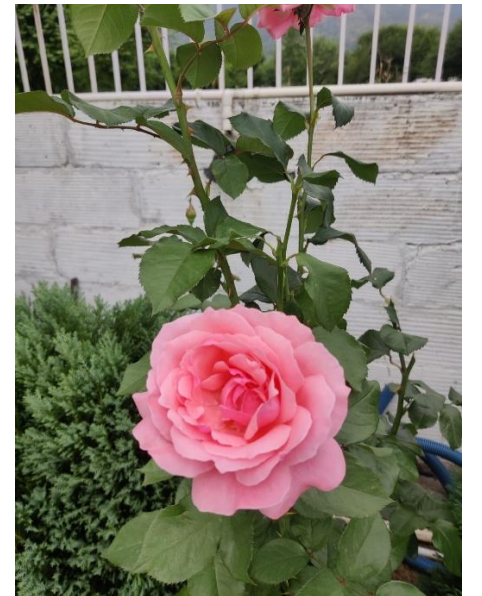
The fourth mode of speech is used only by humans . Then there is another mantra it says the universal gross manifestation of vak comprises the expression of beasts . One commentary on rikveda says that in the verbiage of Vedic dictum pashu or a beast is another synonym of the humans ,till they are spiritually enlightened . The agamas define “pashu” as a Brahmin desirous of spiritual intimidation or Deeksha.

Unenlightened creatures are confined only to this grossest fourth mode . In this word is way different from meaning . You don’t mean what you say and say what you mean that too with every one listening .by the virtue of its name Vaikhari it involves Kharata or gross ness .

Other three latent modes of expression and man’s adherence to them determines his spiritual disposition. One popular tantrik canon named virupaksha panchashika gives us a knack as to how to get seated in our essential nature by alphabetic word transcendence . All Sanskrit alphabet from अ to ह become the subjective pronoun AHAM denoting the “self”. There is an ancient adage in eastern mysticism परे देवे मनसि एकी भवति upon transcending their respective

conditionings they attain unison with the singular principle . This explains the phenomena which accounts for striking semblance in the experience of various mystics. Thought transcendence of ancient Vedic seers, seance of taciturn hazychaste to the trances of prajna and vipashyana of zen and Buddhist monks -the world mind shares a universal experience and expresses it in various verbiage and lingo . The perineal philosophy of Huxley speaks various languages of east and also the west but meet in the threshold of perpetuated silence . Gibran is talking about the divergence of awareness from inner quietude to conceived and eventually expresses word . This also follows that when you are talking you are actually deviating from your essential nature

Swami Paranand Tirth
Founder President and CEO
YTA yoga tantra and agama (inc)
Centre Yoga tantra et Agama
Président-directeur général
Montreal CANADA .



Editorial



As one progresses on the spiritual journey, one is expected to leave behind the pleasures of the world and focus on the divine within. The idea is to shut down the external noise and move to eternal silence where the divintiy dwells. To hear the divine music 'nada' and experience the divine bliss, this is essential.

As a child I remember reading about Madame Marie Curie's childhood stories. One of them which had a lot of impact on me was the narrative about her siblings who tried to distract her from her reading. They would nudge her, hit her and even build a pillow house on her back yet she would be totally unaware and focused. Highly impressed by this I silently prayed for this kind of undisturbed concentration.

One cannot silence the world but one can with the grace of divine mother cut the noise and choose to stay calm in eternal silence inwardly. The path of the divine mother is to accept everything without getting affected by it. One truly realizes her presence when attachment to few gives way to compassion for all. She dances in our heart when we can truly and with all our heart rejoice at other's happiness and feel their pain. To nurture sensitivity not selectively but as a great force needs one to cultivate the feeling of Kantian 'Disinterestedness' where one has no personal interest. To see the divine dance in all the situations and be able to follow its moves one needs to rise above the limited ego and stay still even though surrounded by the cacophony of the world.

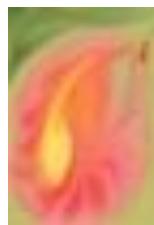
Explaining the notion we begin with the insightful editorial by our Guru Maharaj, Swami Paranand Tirth

ji on the notion of transcending the word and power of silence."Unenlightened creatures are confined only to the grossest fourth mode or Vaikhari. In this word is way different from meaning . You don't mean what you say and say what you mean that too with every one listening by the virtue of its name Vaikhari it involves *Kharata* or grossness." writes Swamiji.

Following this we have an erudite article on 'The Theory of Three Domains' by Mrugendra Vishnu. Atma being immutable, no reverse flow or impact is possible, i.e. Atma cannot be in any way influenced by any happenings in Chitta including entanglement/disentanglement , birth (association with particular body code) / death (dissociation with the same), output karma /input bhoga etc. Such a realization of distinct Atma and Chitta being superimposed to act as Aham leads to cessation of Aham activity. This 'enlightenment' leaves no furthering of Karma, writes the author.

Next we have an academic write-up by Bhoomi Sati on 'The limits of Neuroimaging' and an excerpt on 'The philosophical concept of Lakulisa-Pasupata order by Geetika. This is followed by translation and exposition on 17th and 18th Karika from Ishwar Pratibhijna Karika from the YTA Study Circle and a brief insight into the online classes conducted by YTA. In this issue we present a picturesque Photo Essay 'A visit to Lakhamandal and Mahasu'.

The issue ends with a thought-provoking poem by Ambika Talwar titled 'Love and not love are same'. In this poem she mulls over the elusive nature of love and it's strange ways of manifesting.



Kimiya

The Theory of Three Domains

Mrugendra Vinod

Why is science (or Scientists) afraid of non-physical, non-objective domains?

All our experiences are urging us to expect 3 domains viz. (observed - common objects), (observation –private object), (observer-subject). Let's call them DoO, DoE, DoS respectively. Why not begin our studies with this straight view of the world?

DoO is 'public' or common or shared and is the 'Nature' of natural sciences.

DoE is 'private', visible exclusively to the inner eye or an insider view. This obvious characteristic necessitates its postulation as a distinct domain.

DoS is 'immutable self', never objectified but all observations are for it and from it. The three domain model of the world

DoS: This consists of Atma : Jiva / Brahma depending upon the context
No mass

No volume

No charge etc.

External to DoO and DoE

Entangles the DoE by some process analogous to Super-imposition, Reflection or Conditioning
Immutable

DoE: This consists of Chitta composed of three Gunas
Sattva: conscience

Rajas: action

Tamas:inertia

Mutable

Non-

Physical

(Subtle)

Private

Ever entangled by Jiva / Brahma to become Aham / Ishwara

Forms complex with the body and acts as free agent for output and dependent agent for input. DoO: This consists of living and non-living Body composites

Physical: obeys Laws of physical sciences.

Public: common for all Ahams and Ishwara

Process of Entanglement:

Atma is the Real Self having the convenient property or ability to 'illuminate' the Chitta. Chitta has the convenient property or ability to be 'illuminated' by Atma. Chitta becomes the Apparent Self by such unidirectional process. Chitta has Foreground or consciousness and Background or unconscious store or memory. This memory stores information about Karma, Vasana i.e. likes and dislikes, and Prajna i.e. understanding of Laws of Karma and Nature. This Background memory and Input/Output devices are available to Foreground to focus upon. There is a multiplexor device on the link as well. This whole composite, under entanglement is our Aham / ishvara. We propose some subtle material called Gunas as the material for this Chitta. At present we are tentative about its 'physicality'. We expect this structure to transmigrate from one body to the other. The memory store appears to be inherently infinite but only particular patches are activated and are available under different constraints. No 'initial' blank state can be expected, i.e. we begin our study along the line only. This postulate of eternity is inevitable.

Process of Embodiment:

Any theory that supposes any "external" entity has the critical responsibility of showing how it can interact with the physical reality.

We are proposing Aham as a non-physical composite structure of Gunas. This Aham is supposed to form a complex with Body empirically ascertained as 'This-I'. It is a necessary component of every experience in Wake state.

This complex is especially clear when we start enquiring about "who am I?" or "what am I?" or "what am I doing?" etc.

For example, I am writing.

When I pay a little closer attention, it becomes " This-I am writing". If I look at my hand and say "This is my hand", it appears to be devoid of 'I ness' but when I use it to hold a book it is simply "I am holding a book". We may put it as "My hand is holding a book".

All such self-observations, repeatable by anybody, easily demonstrate the complex of Body and Aham.

We propose that this is due to inherent ability of Aham and a structure inside the cavity of heart of a human being. That is how, when talking about oneself, even a layman touches his heart, invariably, to say 'I am so and so' etc. When one performs some particular function like 'see', 'hear' or even 'think' then one does refer to the organ and say, "I see through my eyes", "I hear through my ears", "I think with my brain" etc.

It is also to be noted that the awareness of body appears to be concurrent with this "This -I" complex formation. We don't perceive the actual process or instance when we spread (sort of) over the body and start sensory-motor operations over it.

We close the eyes and try to "feel" the body. We also make a simple self-suggestion "where am I?" and "from where do I feel this body?" 'I' appears to be a space like thing hanging beyond the body and third eye structure appears to be the organ by which we 'see' or 'feel' the body. Now we ask another question. "Where is my leg?" "Is it far or near?" It appears far off to me. Then I suggest myself to come close. My attention starts retracting, as if having spread from my brow-centre.

If I sufficiently hold my attention, I clearly see that first 'I am' at heart and then 'I see' from eye - centre.

Thus we propose that our external 'Aham' 'enters' into heart cavity by the process of 'made for each other' attachment where 'Aham' becomes 'This-I am'.

Hence, in wake state, it spreads to 'eye centre' to become 'I feel'. From here it does all voluntary sensory and motor functions all too familiar to us.

Similar to this, Ishwara is a Chitta entangled by Brahma. And Ishwara forms a 'This-I' complex with the DoO as his Body. All the individual Bodies are subsets of DoO. Ishwar Chitta has no Vasana and his Prajna is complete. Unlike, Aham multiplexor with restricted bandwidth forcing sequential I/O, it has concurrent I/O capacity.

Karma:

The freedom of Aham to choose between Vasana and Prajna results in special I/O to be called Karma. This freedom manifests in human or higher evolved Bodies only.

Bhoga:

The determinism of Laws of Karma allows Ishwara to do I/O in a way to use Laws of Nature to create situation for the Aham to have a determinate input for his past Karma. This we call Bhoga.

Principle of Exclusion:

Every Aham esp. human performs Karma in exclusion of Karma of all other Ahams as well as his present Bhoga.

This resolves the paradox of Freewill and Determinism. This also rectifies the illusion of Direct Transaction between Ahams.

We illustrate by example. Say, I and You are in Transaction. I have dislike Vasana and respect Prajna giving me choice to either abuse you or not. I choose to abuse, thus setting up Bad Karma. You, meanwhile, might have been doing choice of advising due to Prajna setting up Good Karma.

Now, I appear to receive advice and you abuse, resulting in the association of abuse-advice as cause-effect. We suggest amputating this Direct Transaction with the fullproof intervention of Ishwara. We restore the Law of Karma while respecting Law of Nature, by associating my present Bad Karma to a store for future and your past karma store to be associated with your present Bad Bhoga.

States of wake , dream and sleep:

Wake state: Aham is conscious of the physical Body which is a subset of DoO.

Dream state: Aham is projecting its unconscious Samskara (Background) into conscious (Foreground). Body is ever a part of DoO under the supervision of Ishwara called Prana.

Sleep state: Aham is unconscious of the physical Body and also Samskara. But Chitta is not disentangled and Background Vasana and Prajna remain unaffected. Prana maintains the Body as before.

Transmigration of Aham :

Speculated Aham interacts with the Body to form a (This-I) complex. This complex has birth and death.

Birth is the association of Aham with this particular Body code say DNA combination. Throughout Life this code is carried /replicated while material changes over time.

With the completion of some pre- determined tenure, it appears that this Aham is dissociated from this Body code and this is called Death. All the Karmas performed by this Aham and changes in Vasana and Prajna are no more associated with this body which soon disintegrates and loses significance to this Aham.

This Aham has all the information sufficient for it to be relocated to some other suitable body structure as Bhoga.

About the scope of free external agent in the physical world of determinacy:

Current physical science paradigm envisages a perfectly unique world line. Given a particular state of universe with arbitrary level of description, one can predict its future or past.

But this presumption, though innocuous, is actually fundamentally false because as we go towards the micro cosmos we start losing precise description of reality in any traceable form and it will thus disallow us to predict the future or past.

Our Aham as an external agent can influence the micro cosmos in weighing the equally probable states to biased state. We propose that however fine the detail of physical domain is, there always will remain an equiprobable indeterminacy in the structure. This level is being used to suggest the Act of Natural Intelligence.

Present understandings indicate cell DNA being critical to all biological phenomenon. It seems this DNA strand has a chain of nucleotides, which determine the protein to be synthesized which in turn will decide the body processes. The particular region of DNA to be used as replicator for this vital act then becomes the critical juncture. We might find this act being not due to any physical influence

Here we suggest intervention by the Karma.

The nuclear fusion and fission are considered stochastic processes where quantity of fusion or decay can be found but particulars lose significance. If we postulate the solar radiation as not unidirectional (open arm) but as a feedback loop, we might expect a variable radiation over spatial and time dimensions. Thus every region may receive specific radiation pattern which might be having trigger patterns governing many processes on earth like cloud formation. This gives us Ishwara influence on DoO as a whole resulting in Bhoga of Aham as specific response to their past Karma.

About non-intrusive measurement as input process: Bhoga of Aham.

The physical systems cannot be isolated, though all our intellectual endeavours are to achieve this. Unless we are able to isolate a part from the whole, we cannot achieve reduction of complexity of DoO. Each entity in physical domain is under the influence of entire DoO. What we intuitively understand as 'knowledge' requires us to have no intrusion. Thus knowledge cannot be explained by any physical – physical interaction. With the introduction of Aham as a non-physical entity with three Gunas as constituents, we readily see the plausibility of non-intrusive knowledge.

Disentanglement of Atma from Chitta

The proposed entanglement of immutable Atma with mutable but trans-physical Chitta is ad hoc. From the view point of Entangled Chitta only is such an entanglement a reality. It is taken as the only plausible explanation of all human experiences.

We have also seen that Atma being immutable, no reverse flow or impact is possible, i.e. Atma cannot be in any way influenced by any happenings in Chitta including entanglement/disentanglement, birth (association with particular body code) / death (dissociation with the same), output karma /input bhoga etc. Such a realization of distinct Atma and Chitta being superimposed to act as Aham leads to cessation of Aham activity. This 'enlightenment' leaves no furthering of Karma. Bhoga is seen to be thwarted to Aham and not reaching out to Atma.

This leads to the 'disentanglement' of Chitta. We might repeat, this is only from the angle of 'entangled' entity itself. Thus there is nothing like 'disentanglement' in the 'hypothetical view' of Atma as there never was any entanglement at all! And that is Moksha.

FAQs

1. How many Atmas are there?

The natural answer is: 'how many' does not apply to Atma, it being not objectified.

2. Does Atma come and go?

Again the same answer: Atma has no 'come and go' due to non-physicality.

3. How does one then know Atma ?

Only Atma is knowing whenever, wherever somebody say I or you or he is knowing. So in a way every process of knowing is actually illuminating the Atma as the knower.

4. Is the same Atma in this and that body?

The Body and corresponding Ahams are distinct but no means of distinction are proposed for Atma. It is mere convenience of usage to presume Atma as Jiva and Brahma in the context of Aham and Ishwara as distinct from each other.

5. Whose 'moksha' is being sought?

Of course 'mine'!

Who is 'I' then? Of course 'Atma'!

6. How does this plethora of esoteric entities and processes being proposed help us practically?

It will resolve 'all' the problems of eternal kind. Like:

a) Am I free to do or everything is predetermined?

I am free to do Karma.

I am not free to receive Bhoga.

b) Why was I born?

You are Body-Aham complex.

'Aham' is Chitta in entanglement.

'Atma' is you in reality.

And Atma is not born at all!

c) Why did God create this world of misery?

Ishwara does not create this world. He receives the Karma of Ahams and delivers the Bhoga to them according to his Rule Book.

(Mrugendra Vinod is a scholar of outstanding erudition. Despite his brief stint as an engineer, his knowledge of scriptures and metaphysics is as genuine and exhaustive as that of any professional)

The Limits of Neuroimaging



Bhoomi Sati

Whenever one sees any modern science journal it is common to notice an image of a brain scan: bright red and yellow spots that are frequently referred to as snapshots of ideas, memories, or even intents. The idea that these pictures allow us to "see" the mind in action is interesting. However, do they actually? Can brain scans reveal a person's identity or what they are thinking? From comments about "mind-reading" in courtrooms to showcasing fMRI images in the media, brain scans are used everywhere. These technologies claim to provide us immediate access to our intentions, memories, and thoughts. Can brain scans, however, truly reveal the mind? In a nutshell: not precisely.

The field of neuroimaging has advanced drastically. By using methods like fMRI, we can observe how the blood flows through the brain, revealing which parts are active while we carry out particular tasks. It also does this through detecting changes in oxygen flow. This has increased our understanding of memory, judgement, and can even detect dishonesty. For instance, scientists have discovered specific brain activity when people think of faces they know or recognize or just when they get ready to make a choice

(Logothetis, 2008). The idea that neuroscience may reveal what we are thinking is supported by these discoveries.

However, the majority of philosophers and ethicists advise against taking this jump. According to Illes and Racine (2005), neuroscience challenges ideas of free will and individual identity in ways that genetics has never done. According to Buford and Allhoff (2005), metaphysical concerns cannot be determined solely by brain knowledge. They just respond that the mind is not the brain. Although scans measure brain activity, they cannot access the significance of ideas, or the persistence of a person's identity over time. Hence, it is a little limited.

This is supported by philosophical grounds. According to Hilary Putnam (1975), mental states can manifest in a vast array of distinct physical systems; for instance, pain can be experienced by both humans and a quite different species of animal. In other words, no specific brain state can be linked to the physical foundation of a particular mental state. Similarly, Tyler Burge (1979) demonstrated that our surroundings, or the social world we live in, influence the content of our thoughts. When taken as a whole, these opinions suggest that even the most powerful brain scans are unable to capture all of the mental information.

Now let's consider personal identity. The classic "prince and cobbler" thought experiment by John Locke asks: if a cobbler's body were to contain a prince's mind, who would it be? This argument entails that a person's identity is based on their consciousness, not on their physical body. Although neuroscience can provide insight into memory processes, it is unable to confirm

or deny whether a person's memories actually preserve their identity, according to Buford and Allhoff (2005). Because it relies on ideas of consciousness that go beyond patterns of brain activity, new technologies like fMRI and machine learning are insufficient to address the philosophical problem of personal identity, even though they can read out the content of simple, recently formed memories and thoughts.

Free will must be handled with the same care. The claim that free will is a myth stems from Benjamin Libet's well-known investigations, which demonstrated brain activity before subjects reported making conscious decisions (Libet, 1985). Later critiques (Roskies, 2006) demonstrate that while neuroscience can provide insight into the problem, it cannot resolve it. These issues are not just empirical but philosophical as well.

This is not intended to diminish the importance of neuroscience. In addition to revolutionising psychology and medicine, brain imaging poses important ethical concerns about accountability and privacy (Farah, 2010). Although brain scans provide information, they do not fully depict the individual. Relying too much on them could reduce the complexity of human intellect and decision-making. Brain scans ultimately show the brain, not the mind. Neuroscience is necessary to understand who we are, but philosophy is also necessary to comprehend what science cannot.

References

- Buford, C., & Allhoff, F. (2005). Neuroscience and metaphysics. *The American Journal of Bioethics*, 5(2), 32–35.
- Burge, T. (1979). Individualism and the mental. *Midwest Studies in Philosophy*, 4, 73–121.
- Farah, M. J. (2010). *Neuroethics: An introduction with readings*. MIT Press.
- Illes, J., & Racine, E. (2005). Imaging or imagining? A neuroethics challenge informed by genetics. *The American Journal of Bioethics*, 5(2), 5–18.
- Libet, B. (1985). Unconscious cerebral initiative and the role of conscious will in voluntary action. *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*, 8(4), 529–566.
- Logothetis, N. K. (2008). What we can do and what we cannot do with fMRI. *Nature*, 453(7197), 869–878.
- Putnam, H. (1975). The nature of mental states. In *Mind, language, and reality: Philosophical papers (Vol. 2)*. Cambridge University Press.
- Roskies, A. L. (2006). Neuroscientific challenges to free will and responsibility. *Trends in Cognitive Sciences*, 10(9), 419–423.

(Bhoomi Sati is pursuing her Ph.D in Psychology from the Concordia University, Montreal. Even as a research scholar of Psychology she has a bent towards Hindu mysticism and classical Indian music especially Sitar)

The Philosophical Context of Lakulisa-Pasupata Order

Geetika

The only way to reconstruct the theology and ritual of the Lakulisa-Pasupatas, the highly diffused sect of early Saivism, is to resort to their basic texts, the Pasupata sutras (PS)¹, along with its commentary, the Pancharthabhasya (PABh) by Kaundinya and Ganakarika (GK)² with the ratnatika (RT) by Bhasarvajna.

Prior to the publication of these basic texts, the only systematic account of Pasupata theology and ritual available to the scholars was Madhava's Nakulisapasupatadarsanam, the sixth chapter of his Sarvadarsanasamgraha (SDS)³. Moreover there are sporadic references to their practice in Sanskrit katha literature and dramas and also a brief but fairly accurate information in the commentators remarks on the Brahmasutra 2.2.37, where the Vedantin refutes Pasupata Saivism.

Based on such cursory information the system was commented upon by stalwarts like Gopinath Kaviraj⁴, S.Levi⁵, H.T Colebrooke⁶ R.G Bhandarkar⁷ E.B. Cowell and A.E.Gough who translated the entire text of SDS. Levi in his work on SDS in 1889 had earlier lamented the loss of PS and GK because it was realized that Madhava's account owed a lot to both these texts and its commentaries. Hence when finally these texts were published many scholars like K.C Pandey⁸, J.Gonda⁹ and others took interest and tried to either refer to them or translate portions from them. It was finally S.N Dasgupta¹⁰ who in his pioneering work on the history of Indian philosophy first gave a brief but very useful outline of the system, based on the PABh of Kaundinya. He also discussed various problems of Pasupata Saivism and studied its connection with other schools of Indian philosophy.

Brief summary of PS as collated from various above mentioned sources

¹*Pasupata Sutra*, Ed by R.A Shastri, University of Trivandrum, Trivandrum, 1940

Pasupata Sutra with Panchartha Bhasya of Kanundinya Trans. by Haripada Chakraborti, Academic Publishers, Calcutta, 1970

Pasupata Sutra, Pancartha Bhasya with commentary, Ganakarika of Bhasarvajna, Vayusamhita, Siva Purana, Brahmasutrasankarabhasya, Sankaradigvijaya and Nakulisapasupat darsan Ed. by Alokmani Tripathi, Delhi, 1998

² *Ganakarika* of Acharya Bhasarvajna, Ed by Chimanlal D. Dalal, Oriental Institute, M.S.U, Baroda, 1966

³ E.B.Cowell and A.E Gough Ed. And Trans: 'The Sarvadarsanasamgraha or Review of the Different Systems of Hindu Philosophy by Madhava Acharya, Trubners Oriental Series, London (1882)

⁴ Kaviraj Gopinath, 'Notes on Pasupata Philosophy, Antiquity of the Pasupata Sect, The Princess of Wales Saraswati Bhavana Studies, Vol 9, sec II 99-106, 1934),

⁵ Levi S. 'Deux chapitres de Sarvadarsanasamgraha', Bibliotheque de l'Ecole des Hautes Etudes, Sciences religieuses, vol I 281 ff, 1889)

⁶ Colebrooke H.T. 'On the Philosophy of the Hindus, Transactions of the Royal Asiatic Society of Great Britain and Ireland, vol I, 569-574, 1828

⁷ Bhandarkar R.G., 'Vaisnavism, Saivism and Minor Religious Systems, Strassburg, 1913 pg 121-124

⁸ Pandey K.C. 'Bhaskari, vol 3 no. 84, The Princess of Wales Saraswati Bhavana Text, (Lucknow, 1954)

⁹ Gonda, J. Visnuism and Sivaism: A Comparison. New Delhi: Munshiram Manoharlal, 1976

¹⁰ Dasgupta S.N. 'Doctrine of the Pasupata Sutras, A history of Indian Philosophy, vol V, Delhi, 1975 pp130-148)

It is believed that Siva incarnated himself as Nakulisa, the 28th incarnation according to both Vayu Purana and Linga Purana. This incarnation is supposed to be the author of PS.

Sastri¹¹ thinks that Kaundinya the commentator on PABh may have lived between 4th -6th AD.

PS along with bhashya of Kaundinya do not give us any philosophy of Saivism per se. They deal mostly with the ritual or rather modes of life. As Dasgupta suggests it may be quite plausible that such ascetic forms of life as mentioned in these texts existed from early times and that later the philosophy of Saivism was added. Though the rituals and vidhis mentioned had hardly any visible connection with the later Saiva philosophy, they have a general anthropological and religious interest, as these forms of asceticism remain connected with the life of those who believe in Saiva philosophy, however abstract it might have become. Even in SDS of Madhavacharya the Pasupata system is not identified with any form of philosophy but with different kinds of ascetic practices.

Kaundinya in the beginning of his bhasya offers adoration to Pasupati who has created the whole world beginning from the Brahman for the good of all. He says that the five subjects of discussion in the Pasupata system are:

Karya (effect)

Karana (cause)

Yoga (meditation)

Vidhi (Behaviour)

Dukhanta (cessation of sorrows)

The teaching of Pasupata system is for the total annihilation of all kinds of sorrow and this teaching can only be communicated to proper disciples. When the disciple follows the ascetic practices recommended by

the lord he attains liberation through His grace. Though there is no direct mention of Saktipata but the idea of grace seems to echo the same sentiment and plays a major role in Pasupata philosophy. In PS we are told that liberation comes directly from the grace of Siva and interestingly theory of Karma and rebirth is not given any importance.

The word pasu means all conscious beings, excluding the saints and enlightened beings. Their animality or pasutva consists in the fact that they are both impotent and ignorant of their true selves and this is the cause of their bondage. This bondage which means their complete dependence on the causal power is without a beginning.

The word pasu is connected with the word pasa which means 'cause and effect', technically also called kalā. Hence all pasus are thus bound by the cause and effect, the sense images and their objects and become attached to them. Moreover the word pasu is also derived from the Sanskrit word pasyanti. Though pasus are actually all pervasive and eternal they can only perceive their physical bodies. They do not understand the nature of cause and effect and their general understanding cannot go beyond material and visible world.

An interesting point to note is that a person regarded as fit for receiving diksa or initiation must be a Brahmin with keen senses and disease free body. Chakrabarti¹² observes that the caste distinction was rigidly followed, probably as a reaction against the Buddhist practices.

The word Yoga is used to denote the contact of self with isvara or god (atmesvara-samyogo yogah). The contact thus means that the person who was otherwise engaged in worldly affairs leads himself to the supreme object, or it may also mean that the contact is due to the dual approach of both God and the person until they meet. This yoga must have disinclination to worldly things as the first condition.

¹¹ *Pasupata Sutra*, Ed by R.A Shastri, University of Trivandrum, Trivandrum, 1940

¹² *Pasupata Sutra with Panchartha Bhasya of Kanundinya*
Trans. by Haripada Chakrabarti, Academic Publishers, Calcutta, 1970

This kind of yoga or 'union' as it is used in the text cannot be attained by mere knowledge but one has to follow a certain course of action called yoga-vidhi. Vidhi is of two orders, the principal and the subsidiary. Of these the principal is the direct means of merit, religious exercise known as carya and the subsidiary one is of the purificatory nature. It was mainly because of the nature of these vidhis that the system was criticized by various scholars and religious teachers including the great thinkers like Yamunacarya¹³, Ramanuja and Sankara.

Describing the two kinds of perceptual knowledge Kaundinya distinguishes between sense perception and self perception. Usually most perceptions occur through senses and are regarded as valid proofs (pramana) like you recognize a cow when you see one or you can sense the burning smell from the kitchen and so on. It is the individual perceiver to whom things are proved by means of the pramanas.. Now self perception means the totality of the relation that is produced by citta and antahkarana, ie the mind and the thought. Inferences (anumana) is based on such perceptions. This relationship between the thought, the mind and the self expresses itself in diverse forms and produces diverse impressions and memories. And these lead to other kind of awareness that is the spiritual awareness. This awareness or thought product is called Samvid, Samcintana or Sambodha. It is through these that true knowledge is revealed. The process of knowledge continues from the first moment of inception to the completion of knowledge. This idea of inference has been important for Indian aesthetic thought too, and this can be related to Sri Sankuka's 'Chitraturaganyaya' where he clearly states that art is nothing but inference.

Turning to the practices it is said that one should collect ashes and bake them and then smear the body in the morning, midday and afternoon with these ashes. The real bathing is of course through the attainment of virtue by which the soul is purified. One should also lie down on the ashes. The ashes are to be used for bathing instead of water, both for purification and for bearing the signs of a Saiva. The ashes (bhasma) are therefore

called linga or an indicatory sign of a Pasupata ascetic and distinguish him from ascetics from other sects. The pasupata ascetic may live in the village, in the forest or in any place of pilgrimage and there he may employ himself to various practices.

In introducing moral virtues great emphasis is laid on the yamas consisting of non-injury, celibacy, truthfulness and nonstealing. Next there are niyamas consisting of non-irritability (akrodha), attending to the guru, purity, light diet and carefulness (apramada). Non-injury is highly emphasized as a virtue, almost as strictly as Jains. Brahmacharya meaning all kind of sense control particularly the organ of taste and sex is suggested to be strictly followed. Any kind of association with women is strongly discouraged, hence suggesting that the followers were all young males and there was no place for a woman as a disciple in this harsh ascetic system.

The discussion about truth is quite an interesting one. The final standard of truth is the amount of good that is rendered to people by one's words. It is categorically mentioned that even a misstatement or a false statement if beneficial to all beings should be regarded as preferable to a rigorous truthful statement which benefits no one. Such a diplomatic stance is hardly understandable in such a rigorous and strict ascetic system and seems more in accordance with Kaundinya's time when the order had started gaining popularity among the royal dynasties and lay people. Pasupata system forbids all kind of commercial dealings and trades and an ascetic of this order has to earn his living by mendicancy alone.

It is emphatically laid in the text that a Pasupata ascetic should be a Brahmin and he is prohibited to address women or sudras, except under special circumstance. Under such exceptional circumstances one should purify oneself by bathing in ashes and also by pranayama and muttering of 'rudra gayatri' This is suggested for purifying the mind as there is a chance that the ascetic would get angry and thus cause injury to his mind and probably lose his concentration too. As a fruit of all this staunch asceticism and when the mind is completely purified one attains various miraculous

¹³ *Agamapramanya* of Yamunacharya, Ed. by Dr. M. Narsimhacharya, Oriental Institute, M.S.U. Baroda, 1976

powers. But an ascetic is soon warned of misusing such powers and falling into decadence, the process of spiritual worship can only be done through the surrendering of oneself in one's mind to the supreme lord and one has to continue to do it without losing the focus in between. The lure to use siddhis is great but a true ascetic is supposed to overcome all that and surrender himself completely to Siva. Lord is regarded as Sakala or Niskala, immanent or transcendent but even in His transcendental aspect He has in Him all the powers to extend His grace to all beings. And He is the only one who can bestow the eternal liberation to a devoted ascetic who has completely surrendered to him.

The real Saiva ascetic after acquiring the miraculous powers is supposed to dispense with all the external practices so that no one can recognize him as a Saiva ascetic. Thus ignored by the society his mind will delve more in Siva. He is further asked to move about like a poor lunatic, besmeared with ashes and dirt to create repulsion in people who encounter him and treat him like an outcaste. This insult further helps him on the path of disinclination and spiritual advancement. We might simply understand it as a harsh test of one's patience and humility. When the ascetic bears the insults showered upon him by the ignorant people he rises higher and attains fortitude. Its almost like performing a hard penance in the world to rise over it and its material being. With such behaviour he is not only purified but is spiritually ennobled. Ingalls¹⁴ compares such courting of dishonor by Pasupata ascetics to the similar practice followed by Cynics of ancient Greece. Hara¹⁵ in his monumental work on Pasupata studies hints open the transferring of merit from the abuser to the abused and the use of such technique by Pasupata ascetics to gain maximum merit.

Thus when a person is firm in Yama and Niyama practices and meekly suffers the indignities and abuses showered on him by other people he is considered to be well established in the path of asceticism. Indra is

supposed to have performed this harsh Pasupata vrata to atone for his sin of Brahma hatya

The supreme lord is referred to by many names and yoga in this text means a steady union of the soul with him. Now for this 'sayujyam' (union) the person should be completely detached from all objects present, past and future and be emotionally attached to Mahesvara. The union of self with Siva must be so intimate that no physical sounds and disturbances should lead the person away. In the first stages the attachment with Siva takes place by the withdrawal of the mind from other objects and making it settle on the lord; then the association becomes continuous. This constant or continuous contact constitutes the eternity of self. The self is then regarded as unborn, in the sense that it is not born anew along with the chain of sensations and other activities of mind or in other words it remains the same through all its experiences. At this stage it is called 'Maitra' as it can remain in the state of equanimity and in attachment with the supreme lord when all its desires, antipathies and efforts have disappeared.

The kind of detachment referred in the text can only be attained by the control of all the cognitive and conative senses, manas, buddhi and ahankara. The control of senses here means that their activities should be directed towards good acts and they should not be allowed to stray away into the commission of evil deeds. Moreover Kaundinya categorically states that the definition of final goal as described by philosophers of Samkhya and Yoga schools is not right. According to him the teachings of both these schools are impure and to be finally liberated means to be connected with Lord siva and not to dissociate from all things as preached in these schools.

It is mentioned that a Pasupata ascetic should live on mendicancy alone and should bear all hardships like animals and be satisfied with whatever he gets ,

¹⁴ Ingalls Daniel H.H, Cynics and Pasupatas: The Seeking of Dishonor, Harvard Theological Review 55, no.4, 1962, p.281-98

¹⁵ Hara Minoru. Pasupata Studies ed by Takashima Jun, Vienna, 2002

vegetable or meat by begging.. The yogin who has realized his goal is not affected by any actions or sins. He is also unaffected by any mental troubles or physical diseases. The supreme Lord has the infinite power of knowledge and action by which He controls everything, and this lord should be meditated upon in His aspect as formless (niskala) i.e., formless. In PS 5.7 it is mentioned that god is unassociated with anything that can be expressed by speech. The supreme lord is therefore called Vag –Visuddha. Interestingly at this stage cremation ground is suggested as the place to stay for the ascetic. Hence not having any association with the outside world and taking away his mind from all sense objects he concentrates on the lord. By this means all the network of causes that produce the defects are cut asunder. The defects are classified as various sensations of sound touch etc from which we get the feeling of desire, anger, greed and so on. The suffering of a man commences from the time of birth and continues throughout his life, till the time of his death so the aim of the ascetic is put a stop to his cycles of births and rebirths by fixing his mind on Siva. The self which is thus fixed in Siva becomes static (niskriya) and is also called niskala. The mind in this state is devoid of all good and bad thoughts. When this yoga ideal is reached the person becomes omniscient and he cannot be drawn to any illusory notions.

So the liberated yogin, according to this Saiva yoga, does not become a kevalin like the yogin following the Patanjali yoga, but he becomes omniscient and has no sorrows and this happens by the grace of god. A very strong hint of monotheism can be seen here. He becomes absolutely liberated in the sense that he can arrest any future aggression of evil or time and he is not dependent on anybody. In this way he shares the supreme power of the lord.

A survey of the PS with Kaundinya's bhasya suggests in all probability the same type of Lakulisa Pasupata system as referred by Madhava in SDS in 14th AD. According to Dasgupta¹⁶ it may also be the same system of pasupatas as referred to by Sankara in his bhasya on the second book of the second chapter of the Brahma-

sutra. There is absolutely no reference here to maya nor to the doctrine of monism as propounded by Sankara. Even at the time of emancipation the liberated souls do not become one with Siva. The emancipation here means that by mental steadiness the devotee is in perpetual contact with Siva and this is what is meant by the word 'rudra-sayujya', used often in the text. Apparently as the text suggests, god though omnipotent has no power over liberated souls. He is the creator of world and all the living beings but the system does not make any special effort to explain how this world came into being.

As mentioned earlier Pasupata system as mentioned in this text is represented as a Brahmanical system as only Brahmins could be initiated, but gradually as the order progressed we see the inclusion from all sections of the society which gave a boost to propagation of this order but changed its basic structure.



¹⁶ Dasgupta S.N, History of Indian Philosophy,

Ishwar Pratibhijna Karika

PRATYABHIJNA MADE EASY.



ISHWAR PRATYABHIJNA KARIKA 17 & 18

Ishwar pratyabhijna Karika 17 & 18

इतिप्रकटितोमयासुघटएषमाणो नवो
महागुरुभिरुक्ते शिवदृष्टिशास्त्रेयथा १७

Thus I have exposition-ed the new and flawless path as preached by the great guru Somanand in his treatise named shivdristi.

तदत्रनिदधत्पदं भुवनकर्तृतामात्मनो
विभाव्यशिवतामयीमनिशमाविशन्सिद्ध्यति १८

Merely by taking a single step in this path as aspirant realises his essential nature shivahood- as the creator of all bhuvanas [realms of the universal phenomena] he attains completion by a perpetuated intuitive insight into his universal shivahood

Lineage of the gurus has been mentioned in the consequent karikas

Thus I have exposed this clear and novel path as our great preceptor (somanand nath) has mentioned in his compilation called Shivdristi . Just by treading this

path one attains without any effort having experienced the creator –ship of the entire bhuvanas [ontological specifications of various realms of evolution] which pertains to shiva . The aspirant pervades the creation as the creator did and attains perfection . This path is arcane and thus not popular. It involves no assiduous practice like breath control and internal and external worship etc. (since there are no Karikas on this portion by utpala so abhinav gupta has written the commentary on the concluding verse) the exposing in this context is not spilling the beans but refuting the interjections arising from misreading and misgiving caused by other thinkers .

This path is easy and novel because

- 1 it is/was discreet so far
- 2 It is unconventional because it does not involve much painstaking
- 3 It has been invented by utpaldeva according to the precepts of his preceptor
- 4 all of above .

Prakatito or exposed in this context means

- 1 exposing the esoteric secret of tantras to all and sundry
- 2 this treatise is meant only for the initiated
- 3 the path had to be enunciated in order to prevent the aspirant from getting waylaid by other schools of thought .

Just by stepping on this path an aspirant

- 1 attains unison with the absolute principle
- 2 is assimilated in his universal shivahood
- 3 experiences himself as being the creator of all bhuvanas or realms
- 4 2&3



A brief insight in the online classes conducted by YTA

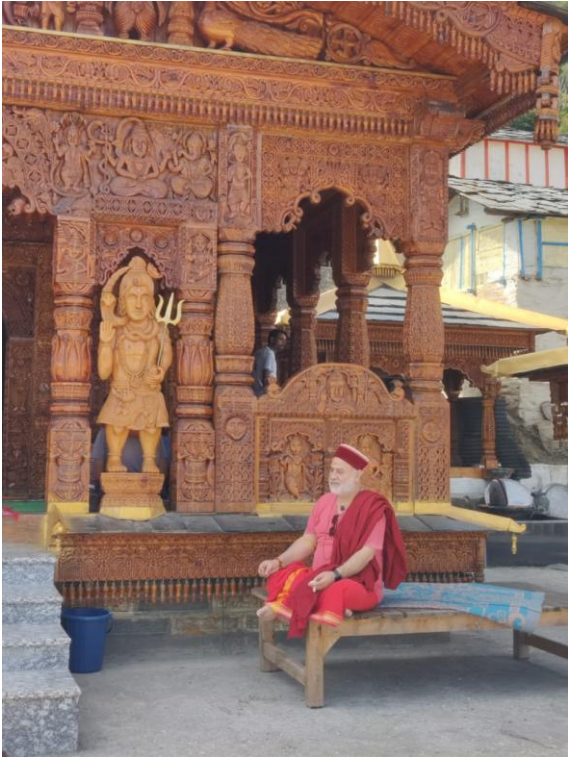
In the Yogtantragama Study Circle we read and discuss many arcane texts in the divine guidance of our Guru Maharaj Swami Paranand Tirth ji. Swamiji reads and explains the metaphysical import of these texts along with conventional commentaries.

Currently we are studying Sri Krishayamalam Mahatantram edited by Shitala Prasad Upadhyay and Brahma Sutra Bhashya of Srikanthacharya with the commentary Shivarkamani Dipika by Appaya Dikshita. While the former is tantric text devoted to union of Tripura Sundari and Krishna and subtly hints at his more esoteric practices, the latter one is a Saivite insight into the Brahma Sutras.

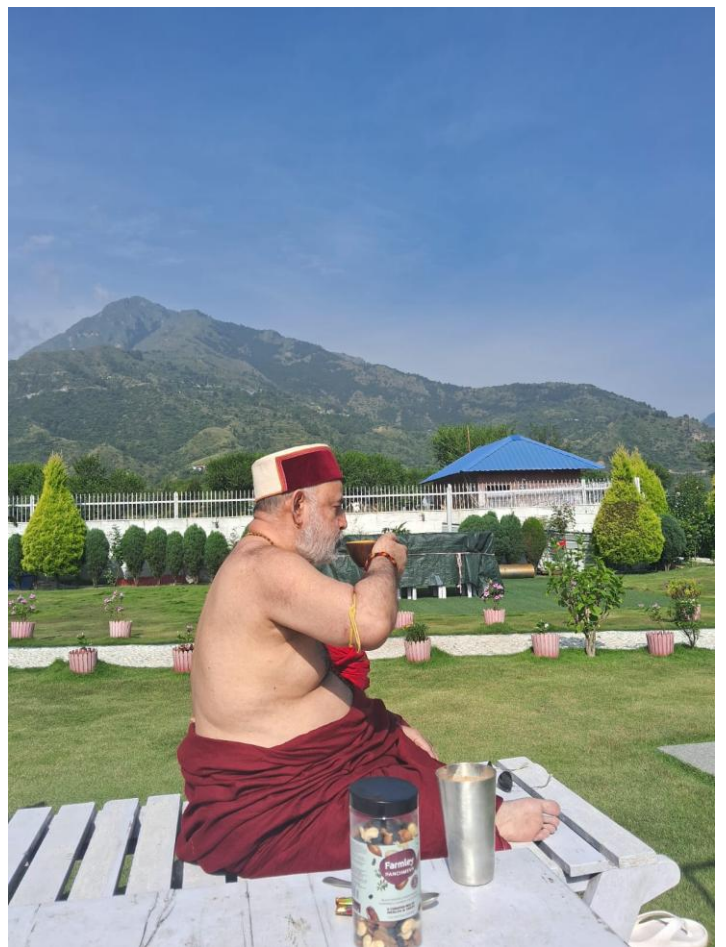
In last few months we have completed the study of Nityasodasikarnava with two commentaries Rjuvimarsini by Sivananda, and Artharatnavali by Vidyananda, Prapanchsara Tantra and Chidgaganchandrika. Though the classes are in sanskrit with a little patience and self study one can immensely benefit from them. Anyone interested to join us may please request Swamiji for the link.



Photo Essay: A Visit to Lakhamandal and Mahasu



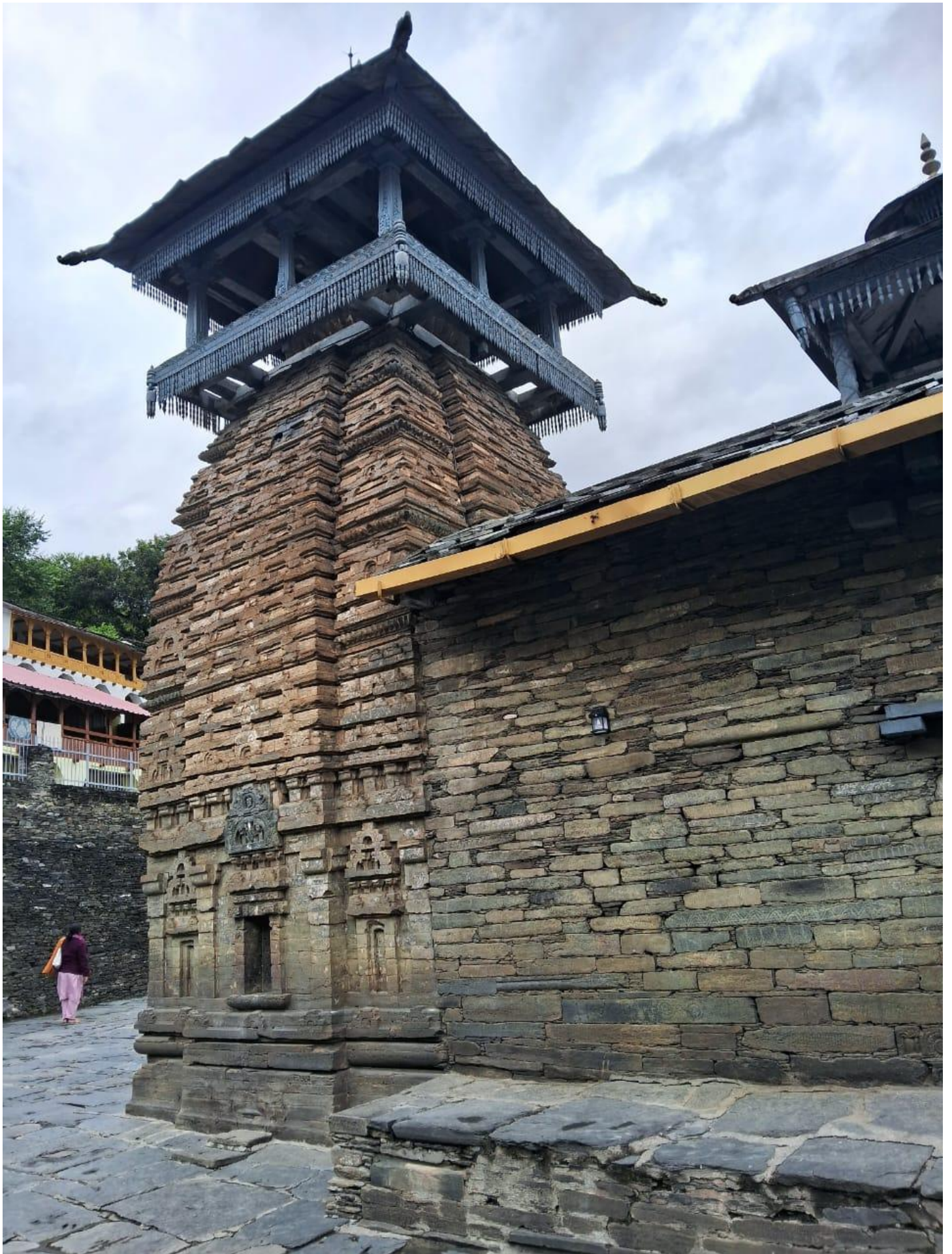


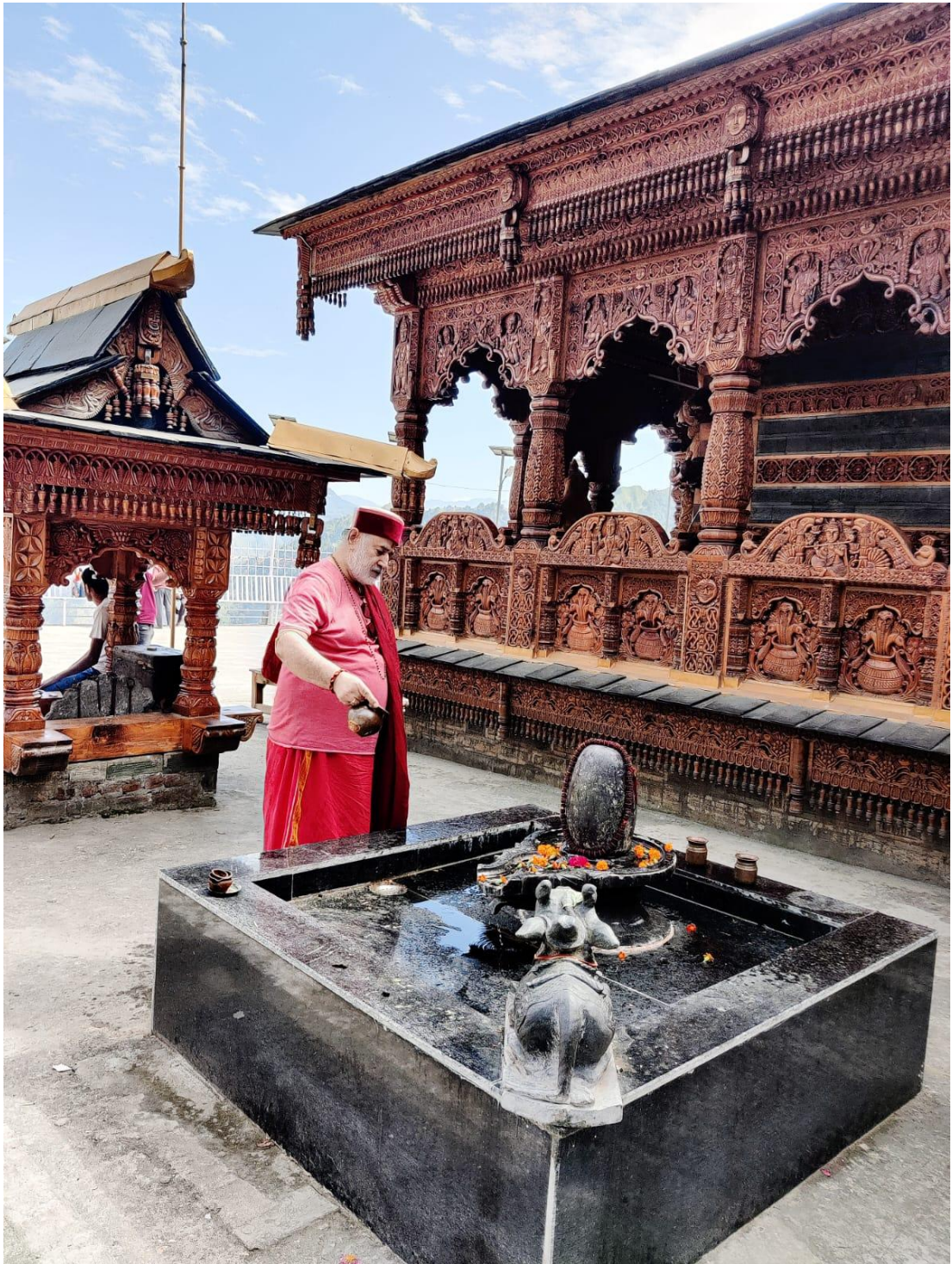












Love and Not Love are same
~ Ambika Talwar



Maybe it is true – maybe it's all illusion
When love stirs, some people swoon,
stand beside a tree and disappear.
Write blurry lines of soppy tunes
for they are a genius at loving.

They have discovered secrets of life
the cosmos and all the other worlds;
they stop eating – as if love would
feed their empty gurgling hunger.
They weaken, look weary and bright,
isn't love the thing for which to give up
everything? Be the sacrifice – movies
have told for decades. Be the simpering
heroine to the love-lorn hero – Or flirt.
Tere ghar ke saamne ek ghar banaounga

Does love make a poet or the loss of love?
tere ghar ke saamne ek ghar banaounga
When glass cracks, *amrit* is spilled
immortality lingers in hinges of arms
of anxiety; door or window swings
when illusions shatter and she leaves

or he disappears: O my, the world ends
as if love were a trick, salve or mirror.

Besotted lover may jump in swollen river
or starve his hungry belly until Death,
or a friend's scolding awaken him again.
May crows go wild – may cat caterwaul
at hero who runs from pillar to post
singing of betrayal while he loses sleep
scribbling sad words with a grieving pen.

I insist love stirred or lost, full or empty
awakening or dying gives rise to new words
to fill a gap or spill the overflowing cup

of life changes we taste from day to day.
It is how life grasps attention for change.
All beings are a poet – we each are
creators of our own destiny of loving –
weave of cosmic indulgence and spanda.
If you know bliss, you also know not bliss.

(Ambika Talwar is an India-born author, poet, wellness consultant, artist, and educator whose vision is to realize her sacred destiny and invite others to brilliance. She has authored *4 Stars and 25 Roses* (poems for her father) and *My Greece: Mirrors & Metamorphoses* about her travels through Greece in 2002.)





Revolutionize Your Lab Setup with
ChemScience's TLG®
Highest Quality
Laboratory Glassware
at affordable and competitive prices.



Serving the North American Scientific Community for More than 2 Decades!

GLASS LAB WARE

FILTRATION PRODUCTS

PLASTIC LAB WARE

METAL LAB WARE



Chem Science Inc.
965 Reverchon St-Laurent (Quebec) Canada H4T 4L2

1 (833) 636-7850
sales@chemscience.com
www.chemscience.com



**YTA Yoga Tantra and
Agama(Inc)**

Published by

Paranand Swami

F-1602, The Resorts

BPTP Greater Faridabad

Haryana .India .121002.

Email:

swamiparanand@gmail.com

